

Mechanics WS 6

1. a. Consider the function $f(x) = x - \frac{g^2}{x} - 2g \ln\left(\frac{x}{g}\right)$, for $x \geq g$.
 - i. Evaluate $f(g)$.
 - ii. Show that $f'(x) = \left(1 - \frac{g}{x}\right)^2$.
 - iii. Explain why $f(x) > 0$ for $x > g$.
- b. A body is moving vertically through a resisting medium, with resistance proportional to its speed. The body is initially fired upwards from the origin with speed v_0 . Let y metres be the height of the object above the origin at time t seconds and let g be the constant acceleration due to gravity. Thus $\frac{d^2y}{dt^2} = -(g + kv)$, where $k > 0$
 - i. Find v as a function of t , and hence show that $k^2y = (g + kv_0)(1 - e^{-kt}) - gkt$
 - ii. Find T , the time taken to reach the maximum height.
 - iii. Show that when $t = 2T$, $k^2y = (g + kv_0) - \left(\frac{g^2}{g + kv_0}\right) - 2g \ln\left(\frac{g + kv_0}{g}\right)$
 - iv. Use this result and part (a) to show that the downwards journey takes longer.
2. A projectile is fired with velocity $V = 30\text{m/s}$ at an angle of 45° to the horizontal. Air resistance is proportional to the velocity. Thus the equations of motion are $\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} = -k\frac{dx}{dt}$ and $\frac{d^2y}{dt^2} = -g - k\frac{dy}{dt}$ where $k = \frac{1}{3}$.
 - a. Show that, at time t , the horizontal displacement is $x = 45\left(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{3}}\right)\sqrt{2}$.
 - b. Find a similar expression for the vertical displacement y as a function of t .
 - c. Hence show that $y = (1 + \sqrt{2})x - 90 \log\left(\frac{45\sqrt{2}}{45\sqrt{2} - x}\right)$
 - d. Accurately plot the function in (c) and use it to estimate the range.
 - e. By way of comparison, show the trajectory for no air resistance on the same graph.
3. A particle of unit mass is projected vertically upwards from a point O , with initial velocity of u m/s, in a medium whose resistance has magnitude kv^2 , where k is a positive constant and v m/s is the velocity after t seconds. Let x be the vertical displacement of the object above the origin after t seconds.

After reaching its maximum height, the particle then falls back to O , experiencing the same resistance.

 - a. Taking upwards as positive, show that $\ddot{x} = -(g + kv^2)$.
 - b. Hence show that the maximum height attained by the particle is $\frac{1}{2k} \ln\left(\frac{g + ku^2}{g}\right)$
 - c. Show that the speed of the particle when it returns to O is $\sqrt{\frac{gu^2}{g + ku^2}}$.
 - d. Find the terminal velocity V of any particle of unit mass falling in this medium subject to the resistance kv^2 . Hence prove that if the particle in part (i) above is projected with velocity V , it will return to O with speed $\frac{V}{\sqrt{2}}$.
4. A particle is released from rest $\frac{5\pi}{3}$ metres to the left of the origin and travels in a straight line. Its velocity is given by $v^2 = 3 - 6 \cos x$.
 - a. Find the acceleration and the direction in which the particle first moves. Explain your answer.
 - b. Where is the particle stationary again?
 - c. Does the particle exhibit SHM?
5. The acceleration of a particle moving in a straight line is given by $\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} = -e^{-2x}$, where x is the displacement, in metres, from the origin and t is the time elapsed in seconds. Initially the particle moves from the origin with velocity 2 metres per second. Find the velocity of the particle at $x = 1$, correct to 2 decimal places.
6. A particle initially at rest at $x = 4$, has an acceleration towards the origin given by $\ddot{x} = -4\left(x + \frac{256}{x^3}\right)$ for $x > 0$

- a. Show that the velocity v is given by $v^2 = 4\left(\frac{256}{x^2} - x^2\right)$.
- b. Explain why the velocity is negative for $0 < x < 4$.
- c. Using $\frac{d}{dx}[\cos^{-1}(\frac{x^2}{16})] = \frac{-2x}{\sqrt{256-x^4}}$, find an expression for the time taken to reach position x
- d. Find the time for the particle to reach $x = 2\sqrt{2}$
7. A particle moves in a straight line from a fixed point, O , along the x -axis. Its velocity, v m/s is given by: $v^2 = 4x^2 - 9$. Initially the particle is located $\sqrt{3}$ m to the right of O and is moving towards the origin.
- a. Find the set of possible values for x .
- b. Find an expression for the acceleration, a .
- c. Describe the motion of the particle.
8. The displacement x metres of a particle is given by $x = 7 + 5 \sin 3t + 6 \cos 3t$ where t is the time in seconds
- a. Show that the particle moves in SHM, stating the centre of motion and period T
- b. Find the maximum speed of the particle
- c. Write $5 \sin 3t + 6 \cos 3t$ in the form $R \cos(3t - \alpha)$ where $R > 0$ and $0 < \alpha < 2\pi$
- d. Graph displacement x versus time t of the particle for $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$
9. A particle is moving in a straight line with its acceleration as a function of x given by $\ddot{x} = -e^{-2x}$. It is initially at the origin and is travelling with a velocity of 1 metre per second.
- a. Show that $\ddot{x} = \frac{1}{e^x}$
- b. Hence derive an expression for the displacement of the particle as a function of t
10. The acceleration of a particle is given by $a = x - 1$, where x is the displacement from the origin. Initially it's at the origin moving with a velocity (v) of 1 m/s.
- a. Show that $v^2 = (x - 1)^2$
- b. Find the speed of the particle when $x = \frac{1}{2}$
- c. Show that $x = 1 - e^{-t}$
- d. Will the particle reach $x = 2$? Justify your answer.
11. The acceleration of a particle P is given by the equation $\ddot{x} = 18x^3 + 27x^2 + 9x$. Initially $x = -2$ and the velocity $v = -6$
- a. Show that $v^2 = 9x^2(1 + x)^2$
- b. Hence or otherwise, show that for some constant C , $\int \frac{1}{x(1+x)} dx = -3t + C$
- c. Find the derivative of $\ln\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right)$
- d. Using the previous results and initial conditions, find x as a function of t
12. A particle is moving in a straight line. At time t seconds it has displacement x metres to the right of a fixed point O on the line and velocity $v \text{ ms}^{-1}$ given by $v = \sin x \cos x$. The particle starts $\frac{\pi}{4}$ metres to the right of O .
- a. Show that $\frac{d}{dx} \ln(\tan x) = \frac{1}{\sin x \cos x}$.
- b. Hence show that the displacement of the particle is given by $x = \tan^{-1}(e^t)$
- c. Find the limiting position of the particle and sketch the graph of x against t .

Answers:

1. (a i) 0, (iii) $f'(x) > 0$ for $x > g$.
That is, f is increasing for $x > g$;
(b ii) $T = \frac{1}{k} \ln \frac{g+kV_0}{g}$
2. (b) $y = 45(2 + \sqrt{2})(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{3}})$;
(d) $R \doteq 44$, here is the trajectory for $0 \leq t \leq 4$. The dotted line is the trajectory for no air resistances.
3. $V = \sqrt{\frac{g}{k}}$
4. a. $\ddot{x} = 3 \sin x$, moves right; b. $x = 2n\pi \pm \frac{\pi}{3}, n \in \mathbb{Z}$; c. not SHM
5. $v = 1.57$
6. c. $t = \frac{1}{4} \cos^{-1}\left(\frac{x^2}{16}\right)$; d. $t = \frac{\pi}{12}$
7. a. $x \geq \frac{3}{2}$; b. $a = 4x$; c. from $x = \sqrt{3}$ the particle moves left with speed $\sqrt{3}$. As the acceleration is always directed to right, the particle slows down and stops at $x = \frac{3}{2}$. Due to this acceleration directed to right, the particle changes direction at $x = \frac{3}{2}$ and speeds up continuously
8. $x = 3, T = \frac{2\pi}{3}, 3\sqrt{61}, R = \sqrt{61}, \alpha = \tan^{-1}\frac{5}{6}, t = 0.08s$
9. b. $x = \ln(t + 1)$
10. b. $\frac{1}{2}$ m/s; d. no (prove graphically)
11. $-\frac{1}{x(x+1)}, x = \frac{2}{e^{3t}-2}$
12. c. limiting position is $\frac{\pi}{2}$ metres to the right of O .

